learn to be

**September 9, 2026**

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to provide a letter of recommendation for **N andika Pampana** who has been an invaluable volunteer tutor at Learn To Be during our 2026 Summer Study Buddies program.

Learn To Be is a 501(c)(3) non-profit organization dedicated to providing free, one-on-one online tutoring to underserved youth across the United States. Our mission is to ensure that every student, regardless of their background or socio-economic status, has access to quality education. Each year, our platform connects dedicated volunteer tutors with students in need, providing nearly 500,000 hours of free virtual tutoring since 2008. This collective effort helps bridge the educational achievement gap and brings us closer to a more just and equitable world.

As the Director of Operations at Learn To Be, I have had the privilege of working with numerous volunteers, and **N andika** stands out as a dedicated individual who demonstrated unwavering commitment by volunteering a total of **101.66** hours of one-on-one virtual tutoring to Learn To Be students this summer between the dates of June 1, 2026 - August 31, 2026.

**Nandika** has shown a genuine passion for helping students gain confidence in their academic abilities. Their commitment to this program exemplifies their dedication to connecting with others and mentoring them to grow as individuals and leaders.

What sets **Nandika** apart is her ability to see an unmet need and take the initiative to do something about it. At Learn To Be, she helped expand our mission beyond traditional tutoring by introducing **computer science** and **technology classes**, giving students across the country opportunities to explore HTML, Java, Python, C++, hardware, and digital circuits. Through these efforts, over **1,000 students nationwide** have been impacted, gaining access to technical education that may otherwise have been out of reach. Nandika's work has helped make technology more accessible to underserved communities, opening doors to new skills, confidence, and future possibilities. Her impact goes beyond teaching; she has helped us rethink what educational access can look like, and that kind of initiative and compassion is rare.

Sincerely,

Ali Philbrick

LTB Director of Operations
ali.philbrick@learntobe.org
8605 Santa Monica Blvd #50188
West Hollywood, California 90069